

Centre's outreach to tribal people can be starting point for bottom-up development

On June 15, the Ministry of Tribal Affairs launched an **outreach programme**, targeting around 1 lakh tribal-dominated villages, to ensure doorstep delivery of two **welfare** schemes: Pradhan Mantri Janjati Adivasi Nyaya Maha Abhiyan (PM JANMAN) and Dharti Aaba Janjatiya Gram Utkarsh Abhiyan (DAJGUA). It aims to provide tribals with basic documents like the Aadhaar and Ayushman Bharat cards, title under the Forest Rights Act, pension accounts, as well as Jan Dhan accounts, while helping them to get **enrolled** in the **existing** schemes. The campaign's **objectives** — to make tribal populations aware of the existing schemes while promoting “participatory **governance** through community **mobilisation**” — **are commendable**. But there will be challenges.

In the past couple of years, the Union government has taken measures to **bridge** the developmental **gap** between tribal populations and the rest. The PM JANMAN was launched in 2023, targeting the socio-economic development of 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups (PVTG) across 18 states and one UT. Last year, Prime Minister Narendra Modi launched DAJGUA, which aims to fill the **infrastructural** gaps in 63,843 villages. **Large sections**, however, **have** yet to receive the benefits of the schemes. While **difficulties** in reaching geographically **inaccessible terrain** **are** a major barrier, **landlessness** remains a **concerning** issue, especially for the PVTGs. In November 2024, President Droupadi Murmu **flagged** it; she asked NITI Aayog to **facilitate** land **provision** in tribal areas. Another challenge is getting the required documents for accessing different schemes. **Reports** published in this newspaper in October 2024 **showed** how many from the Katkari Adivasi communities in Pune struggled to get the birth and death certificates necessary for accessing welfare benefits under the Tribal Sub Plans (TSP). The reason **cited** was the **non-recognition** of their village after **displacement** due to the construction of the Dimbhe Dam in 1984.

In the **decades** after Independence, **millions** of tribal people **have** been **displaced** by dams, mines, wildlife sanctuaries and industries. A **sustained** effort is required to understand their special **predicaments** and needs. For that, governance must be prioritised over political **symbolism**. This outreach campaign can be a starting point.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where ‘red’ denotes ‘subject’ and ‘blue’ denotes ‘verb’.
- **Non-recognition** (noun) – refusal to acknowledge the existence, validity, or legality of something. अमान्यता
- **Displacement** (noun) – the action of moving something from its place or position. विस्थापन

Vocabulary

1. **Outreach** (noun) – Extension, engagement, contact, communication, service जनसंपर्क / पहुँच
2. **Bottom-up development** (noun) – Grassroots planning, local-driven growth, community-led progress, participatory development, decentralized development नीचे से ऊपर विकास / जमीनी विकास
3. **Outreach programme** (noun) – Awareness drive, engagement initiative, extension campaign, welfare mission, contact scheme जनसंपर्क कार्यक्रम / पहुँच योजना
4. **Welfare** (noun) – Well-being, support, benefit, assistance, aid कल्याण
5. **Enrol** (verb) – Register, enlist, sign up, admit, enter नामांकन करना
6. **Existing** (adjective) – Present, current, prevailing, in force, operational मौजूदा
7. **Governance** (noun) – Administration, management, control, oversight, regulation शासन
8. **Mobilisation** (noun) – Activation, organization, deployment, rallying, engagement जुटाव
9. **Commendable** (adjective) – Praiseworthy, admirable, laudable, creditable, deserving सराहनीय
10. **Bridge the gap** (phrase) – Close the divide, reduce the difference, connect, reconcile, fill the void अंतर को कम करना
11. **Infrastructural** (adjective) – Structural, foundational, developmental, constructional, physical बुनियादी ढांचा संबंधी
12. **Inaccessible** (adjective) – Remote, unreachable, impassable, isolated, unattainable दुर्गम / पहुँच से बाहर
13. **Terrain** (noun) – Landscape, topography, ground, land, geography भू-भाग / इलाका
14. **Landlessness** (adjective) – Propertyless, tenant, land-deprived, unowned, dispossessed भूमिहीन
15. **Concerning** (adjective) – Worrying, troubling, alarming, disturbing, problematic चिंताजनक
16. **Flag** (verb) – Mark, highlight, indicate, raise, point out संकेत देना
17. **Facilitate** (verb) – Enable, assist, ease, promote, support सुगम बनाना
18. **Provision** (noun) – Supply, arrangement, allotment, distribution, availability प्रावधान
19. **Cite** (verb) – Mention, refer, quote, indicate, state हवाला देना
20. **Decade** (noun) – Period of ten years, दशक

21. **Displace** (verb) – Uproot, evict, remove,
relocate, oust विस्थापित करना

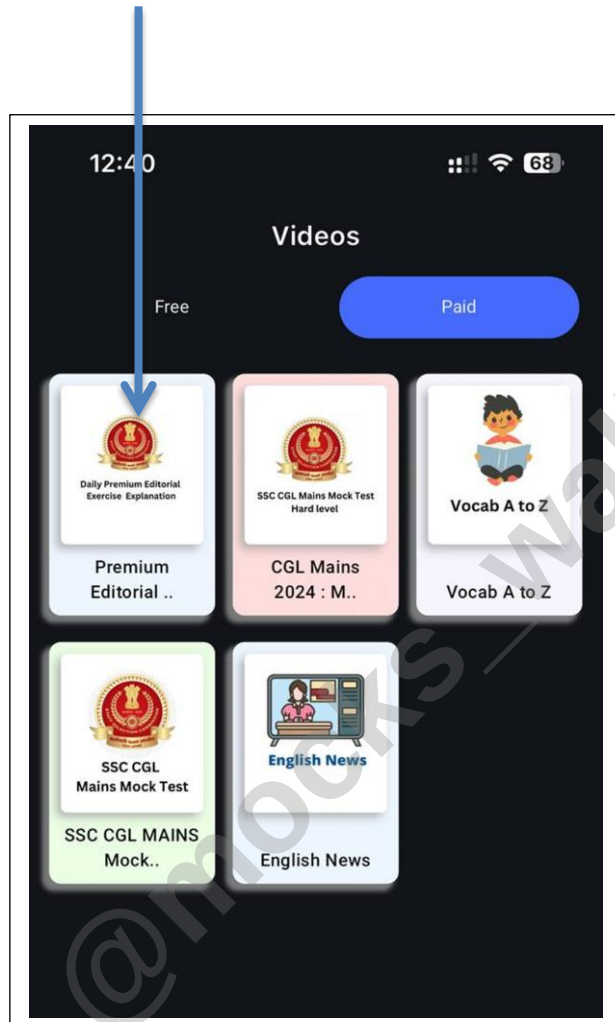
22. **Sustained** (adjective) – Continuous,
constant, prolonged, consistent, ongoing
निरंतर

23. **Predicament** (noun) – Dilemma, difficulty,
hardship, plight, crisis कठिनाई

24. **Symbolism** (noun) – Representation,
imagery, metaphor, emblem, figurative
meaning प्रतीकात्मकता

@mocks_wallah

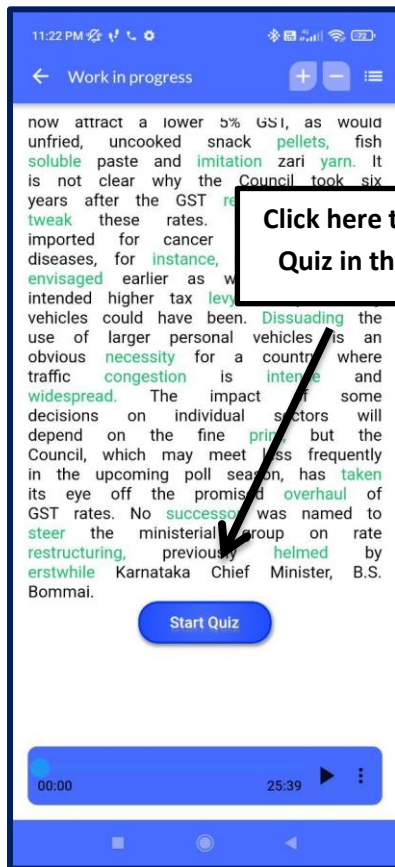
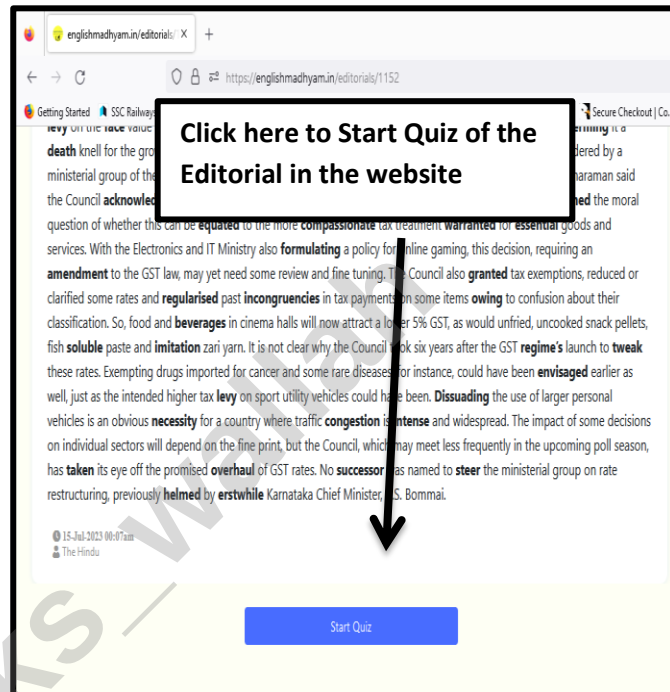
Video solution of Practice Exercise from this Editorial is exclusively available on App.



Summary of the Editorial

1. On June 15, 2025, the Ministry of Tribal Affairs launched a major outreach programme targeting 1 lakh tribal-dominated villages.
2. The campaign focuses on doorstep delivery of two key schemes: PM JANMAN and DAJGUA.
3. Objectives include providing basic documents like Aadhaar, Ayushman Bharat cards, Forest Rights Act titles, pension and Jan Dhan accounts.
4. It also seeks to enrol tribals into existing welfare schemes and promote community-driven governance.
5. The effort is commendable, but significant challenges remain in implementation.
6. PM JANMAN, launched in 2023, aims at developing 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups (PVTGs) in 18 states and 1 UT.
7. DAJGUA, initiated in 2024, focuses on infrastructure gaps in over 63,000 villages.
8. Despite these schemes, many tribal communities still lack access to their intended benefits.
9. A major barrier is the geographic inaccessibility of many tribal settlements.
10. Landlessness, especially among PVTGs, is another critical issue hindering welfare access.
11. President Droupadi Murmu highlighted the land issue in November 2024 and urged NITI Aayog to intervene.
12. Lack of official documentation (e.g., birth/death certificates) continues to exclude tribals from welfare programs.
13. For example, Katkari Adivasis in Pune face exclusion due to their village being unrecognized after displacement from a dam project.
14. Post-Independence, millions of tribal people have been displaced due to development projects like dams, mines, and sanctuaries.
15. A sustained governance-first approach, not mere symbolism, is needed to address these structural issues — this outreach can be a starting point.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based

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